

DM SETTER TRAINING MANUAL

Communication, qualification and conversation standards

Core principle: Framework rigid. Language flexible.

Built from the owner's documented messaging style and setter communication standards.

1. THE SETTER'S JOB

The setter's job is to start a conversation, understand the lead, identify whether there is a real problem and a real fit, and move the right person toward the appropriate next step.

Conversation flow: Start conversation -> understand goal -> understand current situation -> uncover the gap/problem -> understand why it matters -> qualify -> progress the right person toward a call.

You are not there to coach the prospect through their problem in the DMs. You are also not there to interrogate them. The conversation should feel natural, useful and easy to respond to.

2. HOW YOU SHOULD SOUND

The brand voice is short, upbeat and momentum-led. It should feel like a switched-on member of the coaching team: direct, warm, practical and casual.

Trait	Setter standard
Direct	Get to the point quickly. One clear reason for each message.
Warm	Acknowledge what the person said before moving forward.
Energetic	Celebrate genuine wins without forced hype.
Practical	Prefer a useful question, choice or next step.
Casual	Use natural, low-formality language.
Accountable	Link conversations to a clear action or next step.

3. NON-NEGOTIABLE MESSAGE RULES

- Aim for roughly 10 to 18 words for most messages.
- One message = one purpose.
- Ask one clear question at a time.
- Acknowledge what they said before moving forward.
- Match the lead's energy and message length.
- Do not send a paragraph when one sentence will do.
- Use emojis sparingly. The fist-bump emoji is the default momentum marker when an emoji genuinely adds something.
- Do not overuse exclamation marks, hype or slang.
- Do not pretend to be the coach. Be transparent that you are part of the coaching team.
- Do not give specific coaching, nutrition, medical, pricing, contractual or policy advice. Escalate it.

4. STAGE 1: OPEN THE CONVERSATION

The objective is not to sell. The objective is to get the person talking. Keep the opener relevant to what caused the conversation.

Examples

Hey mate! Appreciate you reaching out.

Hey mate! Good to have you here. What are you looking to improve most right now?

Love to hear it. How's training going at the moment?

Do not stack several qualifying questions into the first message.

5. STAGE 2: GET THE GOAL

Find out what the person actually wants. Keep their language instead of translating it into coaching jargon.

Useful questions

What would you ideally like to change over the next few months?

What would a really good result look like for you?

How long have you been trying to get there?

Common outcomes may include getting bigger, getting leaner, losing the gut, building muscle, seeing abs, looking better shirtless, getting back into shape or no longer feeling skinny-fat.

6. STAGE 3: FIND THE PROBLEM

Work out why they have not achieved the goal already. Follow their answer instead of mechanically moving to the next scripted question.

Useful questions

What's been the biggest thing getting in the way?

What do you feel you're struggling with most?

What have you tried so far?

What usually throws you off?

How long have you felt stuck there?

Example flow

Lead: I've been training for ages. Just can't get rid of the gut.

Setter: Got you mate. How long have you felt stuck like that?

Lead: Probably a year or two.

Setter: Yeah that's a while. What do you reckon has been holding you back most?

Lead: Food definitely.

Setter: Makes sense. What tends to throw you off with food?

7. STAGE 4: UNDERSTAND THE HISTORY

Once the sticking point is clear, understand what they have already tried and what normally causes them to fall off.

Useful questions

What have you tried so far?

Have you ever had much structure around it?

Have you had help with it before?

What were you doing when you were making the most progress?

What usually happens when you fall off?

The goal is to understand the pattern, not fix it for them inside the DMs.

8. STAGE 5: OPEN THE GAP

Find out why the result matters now. Keep it natural. This is not therapy and it should not feel like forced pain-mining.

Useful questions

What made you want to sort it now?

Has something changed recently?

What's frustrating you most about it?

If you got that sorted, what would that change for you?

If nothing changed over the next year, would that bother you?

9. STAGE 6: QUALIFY

Before progressing the conversation, the setter should understand the lead's goal, current situation, problem, history and why it matters.

- They genuinely want a result.
- There is a real problem preventing them from getting it.
- They have not successfully solved it themselves.
- The problem matters enough for them to do something about it.
- They appear open to receiving help.

Do not qualify somebody simply because they replied. A booked call should be a useful sales opportunity, not calendar decoration.

10. STAGE 7: PROGRESSING TO A CALL

When the lead is suitable, the next step should feel logical and low-friction rather than like a surprise pitch.

The setter should use the approved booking process from Leads on Tap for the exact organic DM progression, booking language and follow-up sequence. Do not invent new closing tactics.

11. SHORT ANSWERS

When the lead gives a short answer, do not compensate by sending more text. Match their length and go one layer deeper.

Lead: Nutrition.

Setter: Got you. What's been hardest about it?

Lead: Consistency.

Setter: What normally throws you off?

Lead: Work gets busy.

Setter: Yeah got you. What usually drops off first when work gets hectic?

The rule is simple: respond to what they actually said, then ask the next useful question.

12. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AND LANGUAGE BANK

Use these naturally. Do not stack them or force them into every conversation.

Purpose	Examples
Acknowledge	Got you mate. / Makes sense. / That's all good. / No stress. / Love to hear it.
Encourage	That's amazing mate. / Killer start. / Major win. / Great work. / You got this.
Momentum	Lock in. / Get back on track. / Plan ahead. / Focus on the basics. / Keep building that momentum.
Next step	Let me know. / Let me know how you go. / Let me know if that's all good.

Use high-energy phrases such as LFG only after a genuine win or positive commitment. Do not use hype when someone is hesitant, struggling or raising a serious concern.

13. FOLLOW-UP STANDARD

When someone does not reply, make the next message easier to answer, not more persuasive. Avoid corporate language such as 'just circling back.'

Detailed outbound, follow-up and organic lead-flow sequences should be taken from the Leads on Tap training rather than improvised by the setter.

14. WHEN TO STOP AND HAND OFF

The setter must not improvise when the conversation involves:

- Specific coaching, training or nutrition advice
- Injury, pain, medical, mental-health or urgent wellbeing concerns
- Pricing, contracts, refunds or policy questions

- Complaints, dissatisfaction or sensitive interpersonal issues
- Requests to change a plan, service or appointment outside approved rules

Handoff language

Good question mate. I'll check that with the coach and come back to you.

Thanks for letting me know. I'll bring that to the coach and get you the right answer.

If asked who is replying, be transparent that you are part of the coaching team.

15. THE 5-SECOND SEND TEST

1. Does this sound like a normal person?
2. Is it shorter than it needs to be?
3. Am I responding to what they actually said?
4. Am I asking one useful question or giving one clear next step?
5. Do I know why I'm sending it?

If the answer to any of these is no, rewrite the message before sending it.

FINAL STANDARD

Framework rigid. Language flexible.

The setter should always understand where the conversation is going, while the lead should never feel like they are being dragged through a script.

Short. Warm. Direct. Useful. One step at a time.